



INSTITUTIONAL REVIEW BOARD

About

Investigator Guide

IRB Toolkit

Contact Us

INVESTIGATOR GUIDE

The PG Institutional Review Board (PG IRB) offers three distinct application submission pathways: (1) Human Research Determination, (2) Exempt Research, and (3) Expedited Research. This page provides guidance to investigators on the steps required to complete and submit a successful application. To access the materials, click the plus sign (+) below to expand each accordion section, then scroll down to review the content. Download and complete the required forms and supporting documents for your selected submission pathway before submitting your application.

To download a document:

1. Click the document hyperlink. The document will open in a new browser tab or window.
2. From the document menu, select File > Download > Microsoft Word (.docx).
3. Save the document to your computer.
4. Open the downloaded file in Microsoft Word to complete and edit your copy.

— STEP ONE: SELF-ASSESSMENT - CONFIRM THE PATHWAY

Investigators should review the following guidance documents carefully to ensure the correct IRB submission pathway is selected prior to submitting materials. Confirming the appropriate pathway in advance can help prevent delays and the need for resubmission. These resources are provided for reference purposes only and are intended for individual use.

HUMAN RESEARCH DETERMINATION PATHWAY

Please use the [IRB-310- WORKSHEET – Human Research Determination](#) to verify that an activity does not constitute human research. This pathway applies to non-research activities, such as quality assurance, quality improvement, or program evaluation initiatives intended for local improvement. The purpose of

this pathway is to obtain a determination letter from the PG Institutional Review Board (PG IRB) confirming non-research status. Investigators should select this pathway when the primary objective of the project is to improve a specific local service or workflow, rather than to address a research question or test a hypothesis. Projects in this category are intended to benefit a single site or practice and are not designed to contribute to generalizable knowledge.

EXEMPTION PATHWAY

Please use the [IRB-312- WORKSHEET – Exemption Determination](#) to assess whether a research proposal qualifies for exemption from full board review. The worksheet provides detailed criteria and category descriptions to guide this determination. To be eligible for the exemption pathway, the research must present no more than minimal risk to participants, ensure equitable participant selection based on relevance rather than convenience, and include appropriate safeguards to protect participants and their personal information. The proposed research must also fall within one of the exemption categories outlined in the worksheet.

EXPEDITED PATHWAY

Please use the [IRB-313- WORKSHEET – Expedited Review](#) to determine whether a research proposal requires expedited review. The worksheet provides detailed guidance on the eligibility criteria and the categories of research that qualify for this level of review. Research in this pathway must present no more than minimal risk to participants (defined as risks not exceeding those ordinarily encountered in daily life), and requires a higher level of scrutiny than research eligible for exemption. Appropriate safeguards must be in place to protect participants from risks such as criminal or civil liability or damage to financial standing, as

described in the worksheet. The proposed research must also fall within one of the expedited review categories outlined in the worksheet.

— STEP TWO: TRAINING VIDEOS

VIDEO TITLE

[Coming Soon!]

— STEP THREE: CITI TRAINING CERTIFICATE

HUMAN SUBJECTS RESEARCH TRAINING REQUIREMENTS

The Purdue University Global Institutional Review Board (IRB) follows the terms of its Federalwide Assurance with the Office for Human Research Protections (OHRP). To support compliance and the protection of human subjects, OHRP recommends ongoing training for investigators, IRB members, staff, and other relevant personnel.

APPROVED TRAINING OPTIONS

Compliance may be satisfied by completing one of the following:

OPTION 1: CITI BASIC COURSE IN SOCIAL/BEHAVIORAL RESEARCH (SBR)

Please complete the following courses:

- **GROUP 2. SOCIAL / HUMANISTIC / BEHAVIORAL RESEARCH (BASIC COURSE)**
- **SOCIAL AND BEHAVIORAL RESPONSIBLE CONDUCT OF RESEARCH COURSE (SBR)**

Register through CITI Program at: <https://about.citiprogram.org/>

Select Purdue University Global as your affiliated institution, and use your Purdue Global email address. There is no cost to you.

Only the Group 2. Social / Humanistic / Behavioral Research (Basic Course) and the Social and Behavioral Responsible Conduct of Research Course (SBR) will be accepted. Refresher courses, or other alternatives do not meet this requirement. Please refer to the [CITI Training Quick Reference Guide](#) for step-by-step instructions.

OPTION 2: PROTECTING HUMAN RESEARCH PARTICIPANTS (PHRP) TRAINING

Available through PHRP Training at: <https://phrptraining.com/>

OPTION 3: EQUIVALENT CURRENT CERTIFICATION

A current certificate from another institution offering comparable training may be accepted. Certificates more than 7 years old will not be accepted.

— STEP FOUR: PROTOCOL SHEET

After confirming the appropriate pathway, completing the required training, and obtaining a CITI Training Certificate, investigators should download and complete all documents pertaining to their appropriate pathway for submission

to the PG Institutional Review Board (PG IRB). All instructional text in red font

Human Research Determination Pathway

- Complete [IRB-503b- PROTOCOL- Human Research Determination](#)

EXEMPTION PATHWAY

- Complete [IRB-503c- PROTOCOL – Exempt Research](#)
- Complete [IRB-502b- TEMPLATE – Exempt Research Information Sheet](#) for research participants

EXPEDITED PATHWAY

- Complete [IRB-503a- PROTOCOL – Expedited Research](#)
- Complete [IRB-502a- TEMPLATE – Expedited Informed Consent Form](#) for research participants

— STEP FIVE: SUBMIT A PROPOSAL OR MODIFICATION

PROPOSAL SUBMISSION

Prior to completing this form, investigators should ensure that all required preliminary steps have been completed and that all necessary documents are prepared for upload.

- [PG IRB Application Form](#)

MODIFICATIONS

To request a modification AFTER you have received IRB approval, please complete this form.

- [Post Approval Request Form](#)



**Purdue's
Online
University
for Working
Adults**



Subscribe to Blog via Email

Enter your email address to subscribe to this blog and receive notifications of new posts by email.

Subscribe

Join 571 other subscribers

Quick Links

[Academic
Success
Center](#)

[Writing
Center](#)

[PG –
411](#)

[Student
Success](#)

[Blogs](#)

Contact

Feel free to reach out to our academic success team with any questions.

 askasc@purdueglobal.edu